China from 2008 to 2011, renders both the denigrators and admirers of India in her candid, perceptive book *Strangers Across the Border: Indian Encounters in Boomtown China*.[45] More than Seth in the 1980s or Vishwanath in the 'lesser known' in the 2000s, Patil deals with urban, developed China and Sino-Indian encounters in more upmarket settings. Here, ironically, the ignorance of and disdain for India is far greater than knowledge of and admiration for things Indian.

Patil's account opens with an encounter over cricket – the Indian game 'accidentally invented by the British', in the sociologist Ashis Nandy's famous quip. She finds herself among budding young Chinese players at Tsinghua University in Beijing. Their ignorance about and lack of engagement with India are rather baffling but also amusing. No one at the field shows any interest in Indian cricket. They are blithely unaware that the Cricket World Cup is being played at the time. And they evince little interest in wanting to discuss China's relations with India. When, out of her cricket encounter, she invites two Chinese students to watch the film *Slumdog Millionaire*, she is taken aback. One professes ignorance of Mumbai and the other mortifyingly asks, 'Where is India? Is India near . . . Nepal?'[46]

Ignorance mixes with disdain for India. When a Chinese foreign policy expert at Shanghai's Fudan University asks his students if they like India, they respond with four opinions: 'India is dirty', 'India is poor', 'India invaded and seized China's land', and 'India hosts the Dalai Lama'.[47] Patil reports a similar encounter at Peking University. Here the students 'expressed no interest in the Indian economy growing second fastest after China's'. Nor are they interested in 'Indian tourism and Bollywood movies'. Instead Patil is peppered with questions on 'caste discrimination, poverty and Hindu–Muslim distrust'.[48] When talk turns to *Slumdog Millionaire*, a student asks, 'Is it true that people [throw] dead bodies in the river and bathe in it too? But it's so dirty!' Few see India's rise as 'peaceful'.[49]

When a Chinese broadcasting executive in Chongqing meets Patil and is pressed to reveal his real views of India, he mentions the poor